Luigi Papalia

CYBERSECURITY ENGINEER

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WEB CV cv-for-bending-spoons.pages.dev

Cybersecurity engineer. Since April 2026 I have been responsible for security at Smartness, a hospitality tech company, where I work on **compliance (ISO/IEC 27001, PCI DSS, GDPR), application and cloud security and CI/CD security**. Before that, three years on system security for major Italian banks at NTT DATA. MSc in Cybersecurity from Politecnico di Torino. Early adopter of AI and open-minded: my work is AI-augmented through Claude, which boosts my productivity.

EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Engineer

Apr 2026 – Present

Smartness · hospitality technology

- Responsible for security across the company, doing most of the hands-on work myself.
- Brought ISO/IEC 27001 controls from 13% to 94% passing on Vanta in 6 months (risk assessment, policies, evidence, internal audit).
- Raised GDPR compliance from 21% to 96%.
- Triaged about 31,000 SCA, SAST, DAST and IaC findings in 5 weeks, deciding by risk whether to fix, mitigate, accept or defer each one.
- Built all the security functionality of a payment module from scratch under a tight deadline. The module was certified PCI DSS compliant by a third-party assessor.
- Built a custom CI/CD pipeline with security gates. In its first month, no new SAST/DAST vulnerabilities were introduced.
- Secured the personal and biometric data handled by the self check-in system, which completes 99.98% of check-ins automatically (0.02% go to manual review).

Cybersecurity System Engineer

2023 – 2026

NTT DATA · consulting for major Italian banks

- Reduced L3 tickets from 60 to 5 per month by making better use of Dynatrace, Splunk and Snyk.
- System security for banking clients, often on problems that spanned systems, infrastructure and security.
- Frontman of the cybersecurity team, also covering the human side of security.

Software Developer

2018 – 2023

- Developer role before moving into security.

EXPERTISE

- Application security
  SAST · DAST · SCA · IaC
- DevSecOps and secure CI/CD
- Cloud and runtime security
- Compliance engineering
  ISO/IEC 27001 · PCI DSS · GDPR
- Risk management and internal audit
- AI-augmented engineering
  Claude

TOOLBOX

`Snyk` `Vanta` `Upwind` `Falco` `GCP` `AWS` `GitHub` `Dynatrace` `Splunk`

EDUCATION

MSc, Cybersecurity
Politecnico di Torino
2025

BSc, Computer Engineering
Politecnico di Torino
2023

LANGUAGES

Italian	Native
English	C1

I authorise the processing of the personal data contained in this CV in accordance with Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (GDPR).